AI OPEN
DATA CENTER



The Compliance Gap: ESS Safety in the Age of AI Infrastructure

Joel Chakkalakal *Director of Data Centers and Sustainability, Americase, An Americase International Company—Moderator*

Mike Pagel *Senior Consultant, HazMat Safety Consulting, An Americase International Company*

Mauro Leuce *Senior Director, Global Design & Engineering Standards, Digital Realty*

Shrikanth Venkateshappa *Director of Accounts DACH, Anord Mardix, A Flex Company*



Panel Discussion



Joel Chakkalakal

Director of Data Centers & Sustainability, Americase



Mike Pagel

Senior Consultant, HazMat Safety Consultant



Mauro Leuce

Senior Director – Global Design and Engineering Standards SME Global Design Engineering & Construction, Digital Realty



Shrikanth Venkateshappa

Director of accounts DACH, Anord Mardix, A Flex company

Panel Discussion



Joel Chakkalakal

Director of Data Centers & Sustainability, Americase

As a Lean Six Sigma Master Black Belt, Joel develops end-to-end solutions for our clients that help mitigate their hazardous material risks, leveraging Americase's reliable, superior-quality offerings as the basis of his methodology.

Joel received his Masters in Supply Chain Management from University of Houston after finishing his Bachelor's in Marketing at the University of Texas. While he has only been with the Americase team for one year, his extensive experience with prestigious brands like AWS, Meta, Formula 1 Racing and Coca-Cola. In these roles, Joel led cross functional teams and spearheaded initiatives to overhaul existing systems around the transportation of dangerous goods, resulting in his 180 process optimization projects saving over $960M for his clients.

Americase
CONTAINMENT & PROTECTION

Panel Discussion



Mike Pagel

Senior Consultant, HazMat Safety Consulting

Mike partners with organizations to strengthen and optimize their dangerous goods transportation programs. His work spans customized regulatory training development, on-site storage and transportation compliance audits, special permit and approval support, standard operating procedure (SOP) development, and ongoing strategic consulting.

Mike supports a diverse client base—including medical device manufacturers, e-commerce operations, cosmetics suppliers, third-party logistics providers and carriers, electric vehicle manufacturers, packaging companies, and consumer electronics firms. He helps these organizations navigate complex dangerous goods regulations with practical, defensible solutions that align compliance obligations with operational realities.

Mike began his regulatory career in 2012 at the Hazardous Materials Information Center (HMIC) within the Pipeline and Hazardous Materials Safety Administration (PHMSA) at U.S. Department of Transportation headquarters in Washington, D.C. During his tenure, he responded to thousands of inquiries related to the Hazardous Materials Regulations (HMR), working closely with PHMSA's Rulemaking, Approvals & Permits, and Technical staff. This frontline regulatory experience provided him with deep insight into both the letter and the intent of the regulations—an advantage he now leverages on behalf of his clients.

HazMat Safety Consulting®
REGULATORY COMPLIANCE EXPERTISE

Panel Discussion



Mauro Leuce

Senior Director – Global Design and Engineering Standards SME
Global Design Engineering & Construction, Digital Realty

Mauro serves as Senior Director in the Global Design and Engineering Standards team at Digital Realty, with a distinguished career spanning years in engineering consultancies serving Hyperscalers clients. At Digital Realty, Mauro is instrumental in shaping the future of their product offering, driving innovation with strategic vision to meet the evolving needs of clients around the globe and of new technologies like liquid cooling and AI workloads. Beyond his role, Mauro is a respected thought leader and mentor within the engineering community. He is passionate about sharing his knowledge and expertise, inspiring the next generation of innovators to pursue excellence and push the boundaries of what's possible

DIGITAL REALTY

Panel Discussion



Shrikanth Venkateshappa

Director of accounts DACH,
Anord Mardix, A Flex company

Shrikanth Venkateshappa is an OCP Sub-Project Lead for Energy Storage and High-Temperature Superconducting (HTS) Power Infrastructure, and a data center infrastructure and technology leader with extensive international experience across electrical power systems, critical infrastructure, and the development and commercialization of new technology solutions.

His work focuses on the convergence of power, energy, cooling, and physical infrastructure needed to support the next generation of high-density and AI-driven data centers. He brings an industry perspective shaped by experience across global technology markets, hyperscale data center requirements, product and solution strategy, and large-scale infrastructure implementation.

Within the Open Compute Project, Shrikanth works with the broader industry community to advance open approaches to energy infrastructure, energy storage, and emerging power technologies for future data centers. He is particularly interested in bridging emerging technologies with practical engineering and developing scalable, integrated infrastructure architectures that can enable more efficient, resilient, and sustainable data centers.

ANORD MARDIX
A Flex Company

The Compliance Gap: ESS Safety in the Age of AI Infrastructure

- AI is driving power densities nobody planned for five years ago — and energy storage is racing to keep up. More BBUs per rack. More BESS per campus. More chemistries on the market. But the rules governing how these systems are stored, shipped, installed, and decommissioned vary wildly by country, code, and insurer, and most data center teams don't know what they don't know.
- This session unpacks the newly published OCP white paper, *Requirements for Energy Storage Systems Used in Data Centers (Rev. 1.0)*, through the eyes of the people who wrote it: a hazmat compliance authority which was Mike Pagel with HazMat Safety Consulting (an Americase International company), a hardware OEM standards lead, and a hyperscale operator who has to make it all work across 25+ countries.

Close the Gap: Turn Panel Insights into Operational Action

- Three things to do Monday morning: Audit. Align. Act.
- Turn the OCP ESS white paper into your internal standard — starting this quarter.
- Close the biggest exposure first. Then systematize the rest.
- The compliance gap won’t close itself. Use the framework the panelists just walked you through.

A voice for data centers at the United Nations

- HazMat Safety Consulting is pursuing Observer Status for OCP at the UN Subcommittee of Experts on the Transport of Dangerous Goods.
- The UN Model Regulations are the global baseline for shipping dangerous goods, including lithium batteries used in Data Centers for backup power.
- These rules shape how data center equipment, such as batteries and power systems, moves across borders.

Learn more:



Open Discussion

Scan to get in touch with the panelists and the moderator

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